

Year 4 Grammar - Expanded Noun Groups

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0 Alignment: AC9E4LA08 - understand how noun groups/phrases can be expanded to add precise detail.

Learning Intention

I can build expanded noun groups to give clearer details about people, places and things.

Grammar Strategy

Start with a noun. Add describing words before the noun, then add a phrase after the noun if it helps the reader picture it.

Vocabulary Helper

noun group - a group of words built around a noun

expanded - made more detailed

phrase - a small group of words that adds meaning

Worked Example

The bird rested. -> The small grey bird with a curved beak rested on the branch.

Success Checklist

- ☐ I can name the grammar feature.
- ☐ I can use it in my own sentence.
- ☐ I can explain how it helps the reader.

Mini Practice

Add detail: the cave ->

Add detail: a river ->

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Page 2 - Practice and challenge

Warm Up

1. Underline the noun group: The old wooden gate creaked in the wind.

2. Circle the main noun: a bright red kite with a long tail

Build Your Skills

1. Expand this noun group: the dog

2. Expand this noun group: the classroom

3. Rewrite: The girl opened the box. Add an expanded noun group.

Strong Challenge

Write two sentences about an Australian animal. Use one expanded noun group in each sentence.

High Five!

You used grammar tools to make writing clearer. That is strong author thinking!

I Can Checklist

☐ I tried each section.

☐ I checked my sentence.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____

Next step: _____

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Answer Key and teaching support

Answer Key

1. old wooden gate; bright red kite with a long tail
2. Answers will vary, e.g. the sleepy brown dog near the fence
3. Look for clear detail before or after the noun.

Parent Tip - At Home

At home, play “add one more detail”. Say “the bag”, then take turns adding details: “the heavy school bag with stickers”.

Teacher Tip - In Class

Model one noun group on the board. Colour the main noun first, then add details before and after it.

Mini Rubric

Look for: correct grammar feature, clear meaning, careful punctuation and a sentence that makes sense to the reader.